

Ministry of Forests, Lands and Natural Resource Operations

BC River Forecast Centre

High Streamflow Advisory: Interior

Issued: 21 May 2013 2:10 PM

The BC River Forecast Centre is **issuing a High Streamflow Advisory** for:

- Chilcotin
- Central Interior (including the Nicola River, Salmon River, Shuswap River and surrounding areas)
- Similkameen River

A significant upper-low pressure system is developing through southern BC and Washington State, and is expected to bring an eastern flow of moist air through the BC Interior over the next several days. Heavy rain is expected over Tuesday evening to Wednesday, and another episode over the Thursday to Friday period. Rainfall amounts over this period may be in excess of 75 mm. The heaviest rainfall amounts are currently forecast for the eastern slopes of the Coast and Cascade Mountains, including areas around Princeton through to Lytton and areas west of Williams Lake. Lesser rainfall amounts are forecast through the north and south Okanagan.

River levels through the Interior are expected to rise rapidly throughout Wednesday, with the potential for further rises later in the week. Rivers may reach levels similar to, or slightly higher, than levels previously observed this year. The greatest river level rises are expected in areas with the highest rainfall amounts (discussed above), however other areas may see significant river level rises if they receive more than currently forecast rainfall.

The River Forecast Centre will continue to monitor conditions and will provide updates as conditions warrant.

A **High Streamflow Advisory** means that river levels are rising or expected to rise rapidly, but that no major flooding is expected. Minor flooding in low-lying areas is possible.

A **Flood Watch** means that river levels are rising and will approach or may exceed bankfull. Flooding of areas adjacent to affected rivers may occur.

A **Flood Warning** means that river levels have exceeded bankfull or will exceed bankfull imminently, and that flooding of areas adjacent to the rivers affected will result.